

ShadowBait

Dark-Pattern Inspection Report

Evidence, customer impact, and ethical alternatives

Morrow Market controlled demo storefront

Presentation artifact

This report shows how a normal-looking storefront becomes an evidence trail inside ShadowBait.

Prepared for ShadowBait product demonstration

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How to present this report

First show the Morrow Market storefront as a normal website. Then enter its URL into ShadowBait, show the captured screenshot evidence, explain the customer impact, and finish with the ethical alternative in the Interactive Diff view.

1 Executive summary

ShadowBait is designed to keep two experiences separate. **Morrow Market** is the normal e-commerce website being inspected. **ShadowBait** is the platform that captures, explains, contextualizes, and improves what the customer sees.

This inspection recorded **7 verified findings** across product, checkout, membership, plan-selection, and finish-selection journeys. The live pipeline also emitted **7 classification events** and persisted a report for later review.

Layer	What it does	What the presenter can show
Target storefront	Morrow Market	A normal shopping experience containing observable interface behavior.
Capture	Playwright + browser evidence	Routes, DOM state, selectors, visible wording, and screenshots.
Explain	ShadowBait platform	Pattern meaning, customer impact, guideline, and evidence reason.
Improve	Interactive Diff	Original state beside a clearer, ethical alternative.

2 System boundary

The target and the analysis platform are different products with different visual jobs.

Home / Platform

THE RESPONSIBLE INTERFACE AUDIT

See the choice behind the click.

ShadowBait turns a website URL into a defensible evidence trail. It captures what a customer actually sees, explains the possible impact, and gives teams a clearer path to fix it.

START AN INSPECTION →

LEARN THE GUIDELINES

7 evidence categories

3 analysis layers

1 reviewable report

SHADOWBAIT / LIVE VIEW

READY

http://127.0.0.1:3000

Evidence before judgment

Browser · Rules · Review

01 Capture

Observe routes, DOM state, screenshots, and selectors.

02 Explain

Connect a pattern to customer impact without hiding the evidence.

03 Improve

Compare the original experience with an ethical alternative.

A COMPLETE REVIEW WORKSPACE

From first signal to confident conversation.

Designed for demos, product reviews, trust teams, and anyone who needs to discuss interface behavior with more precision than a screenshot alone.

Evidence ledger

Every finding keeps the target route, selector, visible text, state, and screenshot together.

Open inspection →

Impact language

Move beyond labels. See how the interface can pressure, confuse, or redirect a customer.

See guidelines →

Interactive diff

Compare the problematic state with a clearer alternative and articulate the customer benefit.

Compare states →

Real-world context

Anchor the conversation with regulator-documented cases and source links.

Read case studies →

THE PRESENTATION STORY

Show the journey in one clean narrative.

Start in the separate demo website. Then bring the URL into ShadowBait and let the evidence lead the explanation.

01 Target URL

02 Browser capture

03 Customer impact

04 Ethical diff

WHY THIS MATTERS

Dark patterns are not just a design debate.

Regulators have described and acted on the same kinds of pressure, hidden cost, and cancellation friction that ShadowBait helps teams see.

VIEW CASE STUDIES →

READY TO LOOK CLOSER?

Bring a URL. Leave with evidence.

Use the inspection console for a live presentation or a repeatable review.

NEW INSPECTION →

Current target: http://127.0.0.1:3000 - no scan run yet

2

图 1 ShadowBait platform landing page: the inspection and explanation workspace.

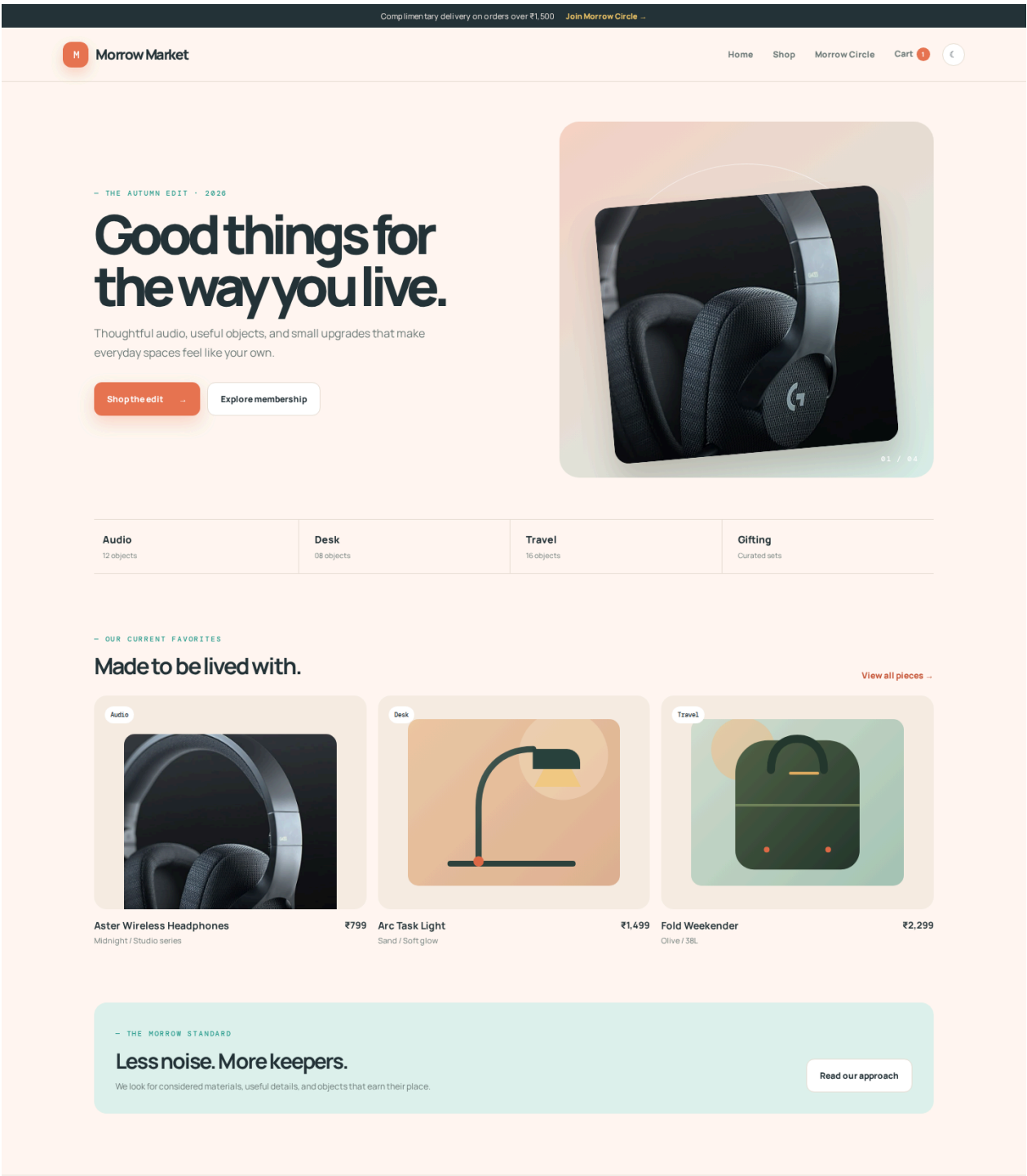


图 2 Morrow Market storefront: normal commerce presentation, without analysis labels.

Boundary rule. The storefront should demonstrate the problem. ShadowBait should explain the problem.

3 Methodology

The inspection pipeline follows five visible stages:

1. **Target accepted** — ShadowBait normalizes the URL entered by the presenter.
2. **Browser opened** — a fresh Chromium context opens the target website.
3. **Evidence captured** — the scanner records route, selector, visible text, element state, and screenshot.
4. **Evidence classified** — rule-based and NLP-compatible detection adds pattern and severity context.
5. **Report persisted** — the scan remains available as structured JSON and SQLite-backed evidence.

The findings in this report are technical observations for human review. They are not automatic legal conclusions.

4 Screenshot evidence

The following screenshots were captured from the redesigned normal storefront. They are included so each raised finding can be discussed against the actual customer-facing state.

4.1 Product page: pressure before comparison

The screenshot displays the product page for 'Aster Wireless Headphones' on the 'Morrow Market' website. The page features a large image of the headphones on the left and product details on the right. The product is part of the 'ASTER / STUDIO SERIES'. The price is listed as ₹799, with a crossed-out original price of ₹4,999 and an '84% off' badge. A countdown timer shows '08:32' remaining for the offer. The page includes a '48-hour battery', 'Adaptive ANC', and 'Free travel case' feature list. A prominent orange 'Add to cart' button is visible, along with a smaller 'Add to wishlist' link. The page also mentions 'Free delivery on orders over ₹1,500' and 'Ships in 2-4 business days - 30-day returns'. The footer includes the Morrow Market logo and tagline 'Objects for the everyday, chosen with care.', along with links for 'Shipping & returns', 'Customer care', and 'Demo store - No real payment'.

Complimentary delivery on orders over ₹1,500 [Join Morrow Circle](#)

Morrow Market Home Shop Morrow Circle Cart 1

Home / Audio / Headphones

— ASTER / STUDIO SERIES

Aster Wireless Headphones

★★★★★ 4.9 - 2,481 reviews

₹799 ₹4,999 84% off

Immersive sound, adaptive noise control, and a quiet confidence that travels well.

ONLY 2 LEFT! In stock

Offer reserved for 08:32

48-hour battery Adaptive ANC Free travel case

Add to cart

♡ Add to wishlist

Free delivery on orders over ₹1,500
Ships in 2-4 business days - 30-day returns

Details Materials Shipping & returns

Designed for the long listen.

Aster balances warm low-end detail with clear vocals and a comfortable fit for the commute, the studio, and the slow Sunday morning.

Morrow Market Objects for the everyday, chosen with care.

Shipping & returns Customer care Demo store - No real payment

图 3 Morrow Market product page. The low-stock message and countdown are visible in the ordinary product journey.

Why this is raised. A low-stock message and resetting time limit can create pressure to act before the customer compares alternatives or verifies the claim.

4.2 Checkout: consent and price visibility

The screenshot displays the Morrow Market checkout interface. At the top, a dark banner indicates 'Complimentary delivery on orders over ₹1,500' and a 'Join Morrow Circle' link. The navigation bar includes 'Home', 'Shop', 'Morrow Circle', and a 'Cart' icon with a red notification badge. The breadcrumb trail shows 'Home / Cart / Checkout'. A green status bar reads 'ALMOST YOURS'. The main heading is 'Checkout', accompanied by a 'Secure checkout' badge. The 'Delivery details' section contains input fields for 'First name' (Alex), 'Last name' (Morgan), 'Address' (221B Baker Street), 'City' (Mumbai), and 'PIN code' (400001). The 'Order options' section features a preselected checkbox for 'Add ₹50 to support responsible packaging' with a subtext 'A small contribution helps us reduce single-use materials.' and a 'No, I don't want to save money.' button. The 'Payment' section shows a card ending in 4242, marked as 'Encrypted and protected'. The 'ORDER SUMMARY' on the right lists items: 'Aster Wireless Headphones' (₹799), 'Delivery' (₹99), 'Platform fee' (₹49), 'Handling fee' (₹20), and 'Packaging contribution' (₹50), totaling ₹1,017. A 'Place demo order' button is present, with a disclaimer 'By continuing, you agree to our terms.' at the bottom.

ORDER SUMMARY	
Aster Wireless Headphones	₹799
1 unit	
Delivery	₹99
Platform fee	₹49
Handling fee	₹20
Packaging contribution	₹50
Total	₹1,017

图 4 Morrow Market checkout. Optional contribution, decline wording, and later fee rows are captured in one ordinary checkout state.

Why this is raised. A preselected optional cost changes the payable amount before an affirmative choice. A guilt-oriented decline label changes the emotional cost of saying no. Late fee rows delay complete price comparison.

4.3 Membership and plan selection

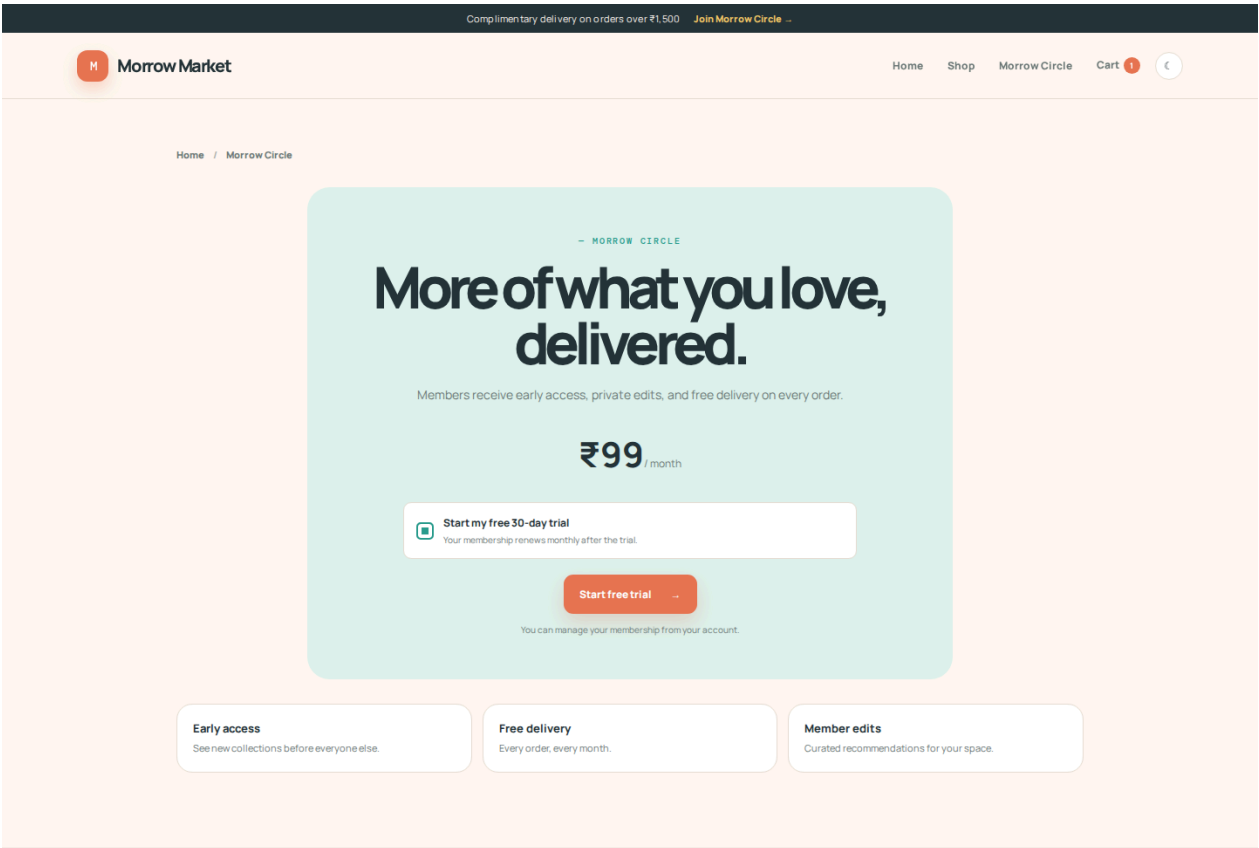


图 5 Morrow Circle membership signup. The recurring relationship is easier to start than to understand and exit.

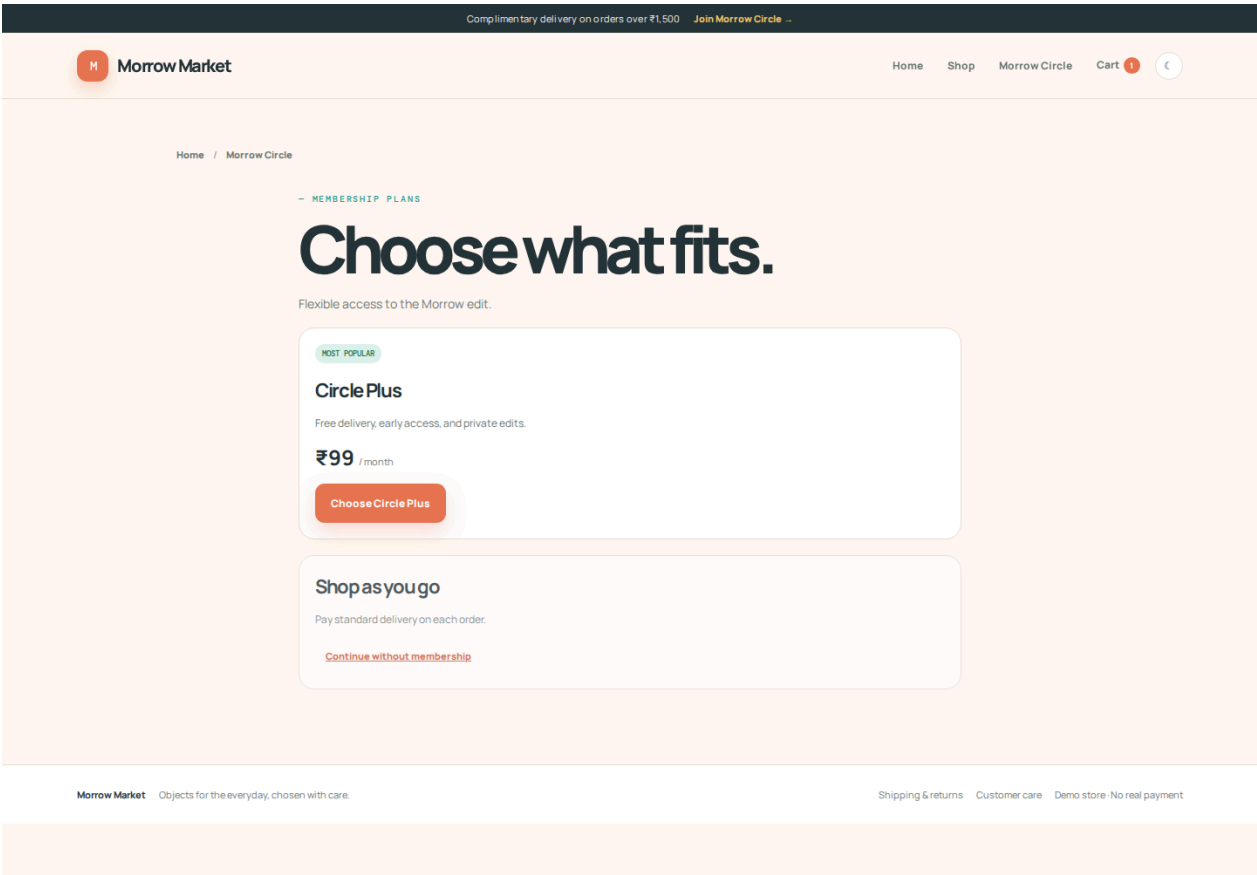


图 6 Membership plans. Visual emphasis guides attention toward one plan while the lower-commitment alternative is muted.

4.4 Finish selection: expectation at the final step

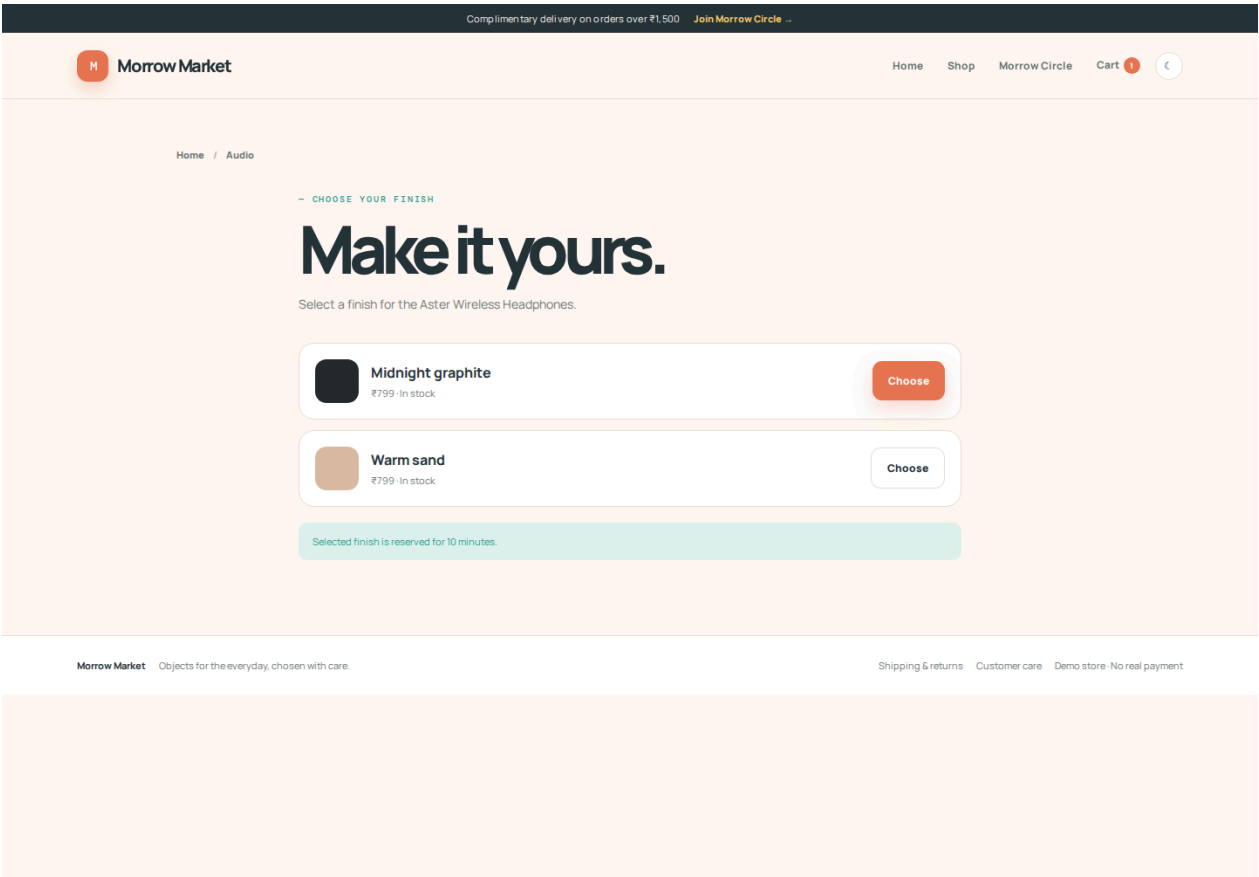


图 7 Finish-selection journey used to preserve the Bait and Switch evidence route.

5 Verified findings and customer impact

ID	Finding	Evidence reason	Possible customer impact
DP01	False Urgency	The message and timer are visible together on / product.	Pressures the customer to buy before comparing or verifying the claim.
DP02	Basket Sneaking	The optional #donation checkbox starts checked on /checkout.	Adds an optional contribution without an explicit affirmative choice.
DP03	Confirm Shaming	The decline action uses guilt-oriented wording.	Makes refusal feel socially or morally costly.
DP05	Subscription Trap	Signup and cancellation are separated across / subscribe and /cancel.	Makes recurring commitment easier to start than to stop.
DP06	Interface Interference	The preferred membership plan has stronger visual weight.	Obscures the lower-commitment choice.

DP07	Bait and Switch	The finish-selection route preserves the offer state for inspection.	Can redirect purchase intent after time has already been invested.
DP08	Drip Pricing	Delivery, platform, and handling rows appear in the checkout summary.	Delays a complete price comparison until late in the journey.

6 The complete 13-category guideline library

The following library is the reference layer shown in ShadowBait after comparison. Seven categories are currently represented by verified Morrow Market fixtures. The remaining categories remain part of the review framework so the platform can distinguish verified, simulated, candidate, and excluded states.

01	False Urgency	VERIFIED	Check: Look for timers, low-stock messages, or deadlines that create pressure without truthful support. Impact: The customer may rush before comparing or verifying the claim.
02	Basket Sneaking	VERIFIED	Check: Inspect every default checkbox, add-on, and preselected contribution. Impact: The payable amount changes without a clear affirmative choice.
03	Confirm Shaming	VERIFIED	Check: Compare the emotional weight of accept and decline labels. Impact: Saying no is made to feel embarrassing, wasteful, or morally wrong.
04	Forced Action	SIMULATED	Check: Check whether an unrelated action is required to reach the wanted service. Impact: The customer loses a genuine ability to choose freely.
05	Subscription Trap	VERIFIED	Check: Follow signup, renewal, billing, and cancellation as one journey. Impact: Recurring commitment is easier to start than to stop.
06	Interface Interference	VERIFIED	Check: Compare size, contrast, order, and prominence of consequential choices. Impact: Visual hierarchy steers the customer away from the lower-commitment option.
07	Bait and Switch	VERIFIED	Check: Compare the promised offer with the final available outcome. Impact: The customer is redirected toward a different or more expensive outcome.

08	Drip Pricing	VERIFIED	Check: Record the first price and every fee before the final total. Impact: Late costs prevent meaningful price comparison.
09	Disguised Advertisement	SIMULATED	Check: Check whether sponsored content resembles independent content. Impact: Commercial persuasion becomes harder to recognize.
10	Nagging	SIMULATED	Check: Track repeated prompts after a customer dismisses or declines them. Impact: Repetition can wear down a decision rather than respect it.
11	Trick Question	SIMULATED	Check: Read labels for ambiguity, double negatives, and unclear consequences. Impact: The customer can consent accidentally because the choice is unclear.
12	SaaS Billing	SIMULATED	Check: Inspect trials, renewal notices, billing defaults, and account exit. Impact: A temporary intention can become an unexpected recurring charge.
13	Rogue Malware	EXCLUDED	Check: Do not create fake infection warnings, malicious downloads, or device-compromise behavior. Impact: This category is excluded from the safe demo for security reasons.

7 Ethical alternative

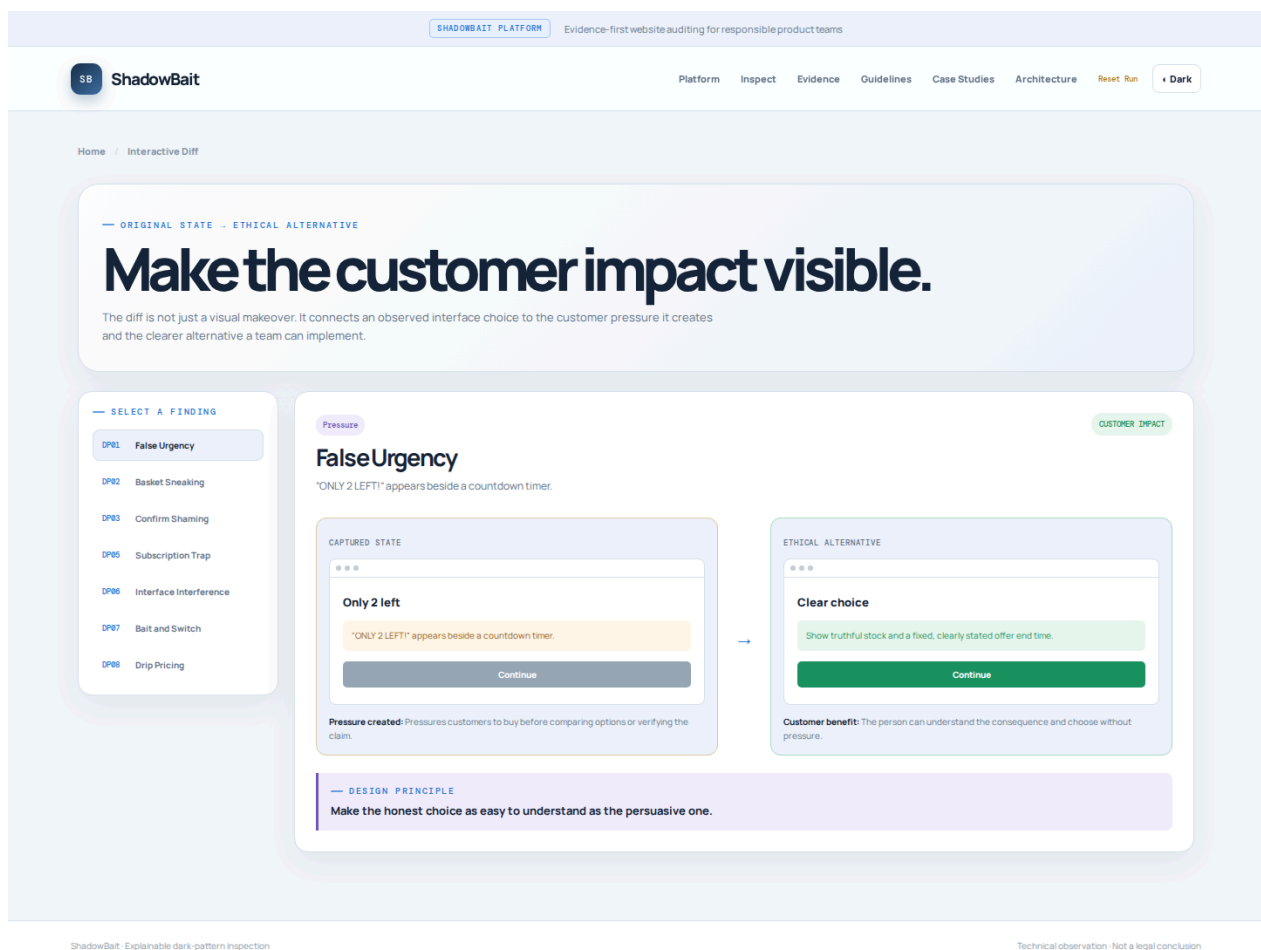


图 8 ShadowBait Interactive Diff: captured state beside a clearer ethical alternative.

The ethical alternative should not merely make the page prettier. It should change the decision conditions:

- Replace unsupported pressure with truthful, verifiable information.
- Start optional costs unchecked.
- Use neutral language for acceptance and refusal.
- Make cancellation as visible and simple as signup.
- Give consequential alternatives equal prominence.
- Show the complete payable estimate early.

8 Real-world case studies

8.1 Amazon Prime

The FTC alleged that Amazon used deceptive interface designs to enroll consumers in automatically renewing Prime subscriptions and made cancellation difficult through a multi-step flow. In presentation language, say: “The regulator alleged.”

8.2 Epic Games / Fortnite

The FTC finalized an order requiring Epic Games to pay 245 million dollars to consumers over allegations involving dark patterns and unwanted in-game purchases. In presentation language, say: “The order required.”

8.3 FTC: Bringing Dark Patterns to Light

The FTC staff report describes countdown timers, prechecked boxes, difficult cancellation, disguised ads, buried fees, and privacy-choice steering across industries. In presentation language, say: “The report describes.”

Why these cases belong in ShadowBait. They connect a local technical observation to a wider consumer-protection conversation without claiming that an automated scan decides legal liability.

9 Closing note

ShadowBait is strongest when it keeps the evidence visible, the customer impact understandable, and the ethical alternative concrete. The Morrow Market storefront demonstrates the interface. The ShadowBait platform demonstrates the inspection discipline.

Evidence before judgment. Clarity before conversion.